

Nova.ai

Human Resources Policy Document

LEAVE POLICY

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1. Purpose

This policy defines the types of leave available to employees of Nova.ai ("the Company"), the eligibility criteria, accrual mechanism, and the process for applying for and approving leave. The objective is to ensure a fair, transparent, and consistent approach to leave management across all departments and locations, while supporting employee well-being and business continuity.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all full-time, confirmed, and probationary employees of the Company across its offices in India, including employees working in hybrid or remote arrangements. Interns and contractors are governed by separate agreements and are not covered under this policy unless explicitly stated in their contract.

3. Leave Year

The leave year for all purposes under this policy shall run from 1 April to 31 March of the following calendar year, in line with the Company's financial year.

4. Types of Leave

4.1 Earned Leave (EL) / Privilege Leave

Employees accrue 1.5 days of Earned Leave per completed month of service, amounting to 18 days per leave year. Earned Leave can be availed for personal reasons, travel, or planned time off and must generally be applied for at least 3 working days in advance. A maximum of 45 days of Earned Leave may be accumulated; any balance beyond this cap will lapse at the end of the leave year unless carried forward under the encashment provision in Section 7.

4.2 Casual Leave (CL)

Employees are entitled to 8 days of Casual Leave per leave year, credited at the start of the year. Casual Leave is intended for short-notice personal matters and may be availed for a maximum of 3 consecutive days at a time without prior approval from HR. Unused Casual Leave does not carry forward to the next leave year and does not qualify for encashment.

4.3 Sick Leave (SL)

Employees are entitled to 10 days of Sick Leave per leave year for genuine illness or medical reasons. A medical certificate from a registered practitioner is mandatory for sick leave exceeding 2 consecutive working days. Sick Leave cannot be availed in advance of accrual and cannot be combined with Casual Leave for periods exceeding 5 consecutive days without HR approval.

4.4 Maternity Leave

In accordance with the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (as amended), women employees who have worked for at least 80 days in the 12 months preceding their expected date of delivery are entitled to 26 weeks of paid Maternity Leave for the first two children, and 12 weeks for subsequent children. Up to 8 weeks may be availed prior to the expected delivery date.

4.5 Paternity Leave

Male employees are entitled to 15 days of paid Paternity Leave, to be availed within 3 months of the child's birth or legal adoption. This leave must be requested at least 2 weeks in advance where the date of delivery is known.

4.6 Bereavement Leave

Employees may avail up to 5 days of paid Bereavement Leave in the event of the death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, or sibling), to be applied for as soon as reasonably practicable.

4.7 Leave Without Pay (LWP)

Where an employee has exhausted all applicable leave balances, Leave Without Pay may be granted at the sole discretion of the Reporting Manager and HR, for a maximum of 30 days in a leave year. Extended LWP beyond this limit requires approval from the Head of HR.

5. Leave Application Process

5.1 All leave requests must be submitted through the Company's HRIS portal, except in emergencies where verbal/email intimation to the Reporting Manager is acceptable, followed by a formal application within 2 working days.

5.2 Planned Earned Leave of 3+ consecutive days must be applied at least 7 working days in advance. Managers must approve or reject requests within 2 working days, failing which requests auto-escalate to the next-level manager.

5.3 Employees must ensure adequate handover before proceeding on leave exceeding 3 working days. Approved leave may be recalled only under exceptional business circumstances, with due notice.

6. Public Holidays

The Company observes 12 public holidays each calendar year, as notified in the annual holiday calendar published by HR in December for the following year. This includes 3 national holidays (Republic Day, Independence Day, Gandhi Jayanti) and up to 9 restricted/regional holidays selected based on office location and applicable state regulations.

7. Leave Encashment

Employees may encash up to 10 days of accumulated Earned Leave once per leave year, subject to a minimum balance of 15 days being retained. Encashment is processed along with the March payroll cycle. Full and final encashment of all eligible leave balances is processed at the time of separation from the Company, as per applicable tax regulations.

8. Leave During Notice Period

Earned Leave may be availed during the notice period only with prior written approval from the Reporting Manager and HR. Casual and Sick Leave cannot ordinarily be availed during the notice period except in genuine medical emergencies supported by valid documentation.

9. Special Provisions

9.1 Compensatory Off & Sabbatical

Employees required to work on a declared public holiday or weekend due to business need may avail Compensatory Off within 30 days. Employees with 3+ years of continuous service may additionally apply for unpaid Sabbatical Leave of up to 3 months, subject to HR and Head of Department approval.

10. Non-Compliance & Policy Ownership

Availing leave without approval, submitting false medical certificates, or repeated unauthorized absence will be treated as misconduct under the Company's Code of Conduct. This policy is owned by the Human Resources department and is subject to periodic review; employees will be notified of any material changes at least 30 days prior to implementation, where feasible.

Annexure A: Leave Entitlement Summary

Leave Type	Annual Entitlement	Carry Forward	Encashment
Earned Leave (EL)	18 days	Yes (max 45 days)	Yes (max 10 days/yr)
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days	No	No
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days	No	No
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	N/A	N/A
Paternity Leave	15 days	N/A	N/A
Bereavement Leave	5 days/event	N/A	N/A

This is a synthetically generated sample HR policy document created for demonstration and portfolio/RAG-project purposes. It does not represent an actual company policy.